



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Wednesday, March 23, 2026, 7:00 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

CALL TO ORDER

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM

PRESENT: Jennifer Milikowsky, Susan Bronstein (Chair), Scott Johndrow (by Zoom).

PUBLIC COMMENT on any item not on the agenda

Ms. Pat Miller requested that the Selectboard close south Road Extension from South Road to Tob Hill Road for an event on April 4, 2026, from 9 AM to Noon.

Ms. Miller was asked to coordinate with the highway Department and the police department in regard to specifics.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the road closure as requested.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:03 PM)

It was noted that the website had the incorrect end time for the election on April 11. Ms. Bronstein noted that the website error had been corrected.

PROJECT PREVIEW–Heat Pumps and Weatherization for Town Hall and Town Hall Annex

Dan Abrahamson, Energy Manager will present the proposed scope of work for the project; the Selectboard will review the grant contract award, take any necessary votes, and sign documents.

Mr Abrahamson reviewed the proposal to improve the weatherization of the Town Hall and the Town Hall Annex, and discussed both the Green Communities / DOER grant award, and the Eversource incentives that will fund the project.

There was discussion about the specifications of the scope of work, and the potential savings to be realized upon completion of the work.

There was discussion about the heat pump systems at the elementary school, and their efficiency. Mr. Abrahamson noted that there has been some savings as a result of a reduction in oil use at the elementary school.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that there should be discussion and consideration of how and when the main hall was air-conditioned.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the proposed grant award contract, and to authorize Ms. Bronstein to sign all documents in the board's behalf.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:19 PM)

HAZARD MITIGATION PLAN AMENDMENT

The Selectboard will review the final draft amendment to the Westhampton Hazard Mitigation Plan. Votes may be taken.

Mr. Finn noted that a final version of the plan was not available for review. The board agreed to table the matter to the next meeting.

DEPARTMENT, BOARD and COMMITTEE REPORTS

Selectboard will receive and act on any board or committee reports or requests.

Highway

Superintendent Bill Jablonski Provided a quick update on work from January and February, including snow removal and road treatment; service of all fire trucks; repairs to the grader for use on the roads; clearing of culvert pipes. Mr. Jablonski noted over 130 hours of overtime by January 31. Quantities for materials have been submitted to the FRCOG in prep for group purchasing.

Mr. Jablonski requested permission to sell the old grader. Ms. Milikowsky asked if the equipment was of no further use. Mr. Jablonski confirmed, and noted that further use may only result in further repair issues.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To declare the grader as surplus and to authorize disposal.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:27 PM)

Mr. Jablonski noted that Ben Warren had stepped in as a reserve snow removal operator from time to time.

Mr. Jablonski requested the go-ahead to post the vacant highway operator position, and begin reviewing applicants.

There was discussion about the requirements for the position, the benefits of hiring a fully-qualified person, and the state regulations that make it very difficult to train on the job.

After discussion, Mr. Jablonski clarified that he was looking to hire an operator, but that the person would start at the probationary rate (\$26.65 / hour), with an increase to the Grade 1 rate (\$30.75) after six months probationary.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky SECONDED by Johndrow

To authorize posting the position and to begin screening candidates.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:38 PM)

Recreation

Ms. Dale Kasal noted that the Recreation Committee was hosting and promoting a CPR class (not for certification, but as an introduction to the skillset). The class will be held at the Town Hall on March 24, 2026 at 6 PM, with about 50 participants signed up for the class. Ms. Kasal noted that 60% of the registrants are from Westhampton, some of which are participating as a family; also noted: about 75% of the registrants expressed interest in a certification class.

Ms. Kasal asked that the town pursue a program to keep the hall floor in good shape, and asked about options for refinishing the floor. The board agreed to look into the matter.

ADMINISTRATIVE

Review and Sign Warrant for Special Town Election to be held on April 11, 2026

The warrant was reviewed.

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve the warrant for a special town election to be held on April 11, 2026, from 8 AM to 5 PM, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (_ PM)

Review and Sign Warrant for Town Caucus to be held on April 13, 2026

The warrant was reviewed.

It was MOVED by _ SECONDED by _

To approve the warrant for the annual town caucus to be held on April 13, 2026, at 6 PM, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (_ PM)

Review a Draft Letter to state legislators expressing support for S.2306 and H.3551

A draft letter was reviewed. It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow
To approve the letter and to sign and send.

Review and Act on any Correspondence

A letter from Scott Stanton, requesting appointment to the Historic Commission, was reviewed.
No action taken, and the matter was tabled to the next regular meeting on April 6, 2026.

Review and approval of minutes of past meetings (March 9, 2026)

Minutes from March 9 were reviewed. Once correction was noted and made.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the minutes from March 9, 2026, as amended, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:58 PM)

Review and approval of AP and Payroll Warrants (W26-19)

Accounts Payable and Payroll Warrants were reviewed.

The solar PV payments were noted as being exceptional, and not recurring.

Ms. Milikowsky noted special education costs were exceptionally high, with some discussion of special education costs as a result.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the A/P and Payroll Warrants W26-19 as presented, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:03 PM)

MEMBER CONCERNS

Board may discuss new topics raised by individual members, deliberate on potential action or future agenda placement, or give direction to staff.

Mr. Johndrow requested a conversation with the Assessors to understand the process of property valuation – and revaluation – and why there appears to be inconsistencies with valuation of properties. Mr. Finn will request that the assessors attend the next meeting to provide a “primer” on property assessment, with an outline of their property valuation processes and procedures.

Presentation: FY2027 Budget

The board will review the presentation materials prepared by the Finance Committee, and the Proposition 2-1/2 override ballot question.

Ms. Milikowsky and Ms. Bronstein provided a preview of the presentation to be made at the public presentation relative to the Prop 2-1/2 override and the FY2027 Budget. The public presentations will be held on March 25, March 31, and April 8.

After the presentation, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To endorse passage of a proposition 2-1/2 override as presented in Option 1.

There was extensive discussion relative to the motion. Mr. Johndrow expressed significant concerns with recommending the option – a \$500k override – when in his opinion, the regional school district appeared to be proposing too high of a budget.

Ms. Milikowsky noted that if the override fails, the Selectboard should support voting down the proposed regional school budget.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:32 PM)

Adjourn

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To Adjourn.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:33 PM)

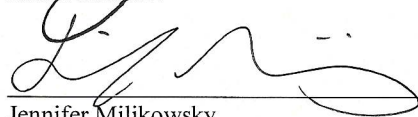
Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on April 6, 2026.



Susan Bronstein



Scott Johndrow



Jennifer Milikowsky